

MINI PROJECT 1

Troubleshooting Log

AWS Web Server Deployment — Task 7

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Course: Cloud Computing

Troubleshooting Log

This log documents three issues encountered during the deployment of the AWS web server. For each issue, the problem, its root cause, and the steps taken to resolve it are described below.

Issue 1: SSH Connection Timed Out

Problem	The ssh command hung indefinitely with no response and eventually timed out with no connection established.
Cause	The route table had not been associated with the public subnet. Without this association, the subnet had no route to the internet even though the Internet Gateway had been created and attached to the VPC.
Solution	Navigated to VPC → Route Tables → selected public-rt → clicked the Subnet Associations tab → clicked Edit subnet associations → selected public-subnet-1 → saved changes. The SSH command connected successfully on the next attempt.

Issue 2: Permission Denied (publickey)

Problem	Running the ssh command returned: Permission denied (publickey). The connection was refused immediately without prompting for any credentials.
Cause	The downloaded .pem key file had permissions set to 644, meaning it was readable by other users on the system. OpenSSH enforces strict permission checks and intentionally rejects key files that are too permissive as a security measure.

Solution	Ran <code>chmod 400 project-key.pem</code> in the terminal to restrict the file to owner-read-only. Re-ran the <code>ssh</code> command and the connection was established successfully.
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Issue 3: Web Page Not Loading in Browser

Problem	After installing Nginx and confirming it was active and running with <code>sudo systemctl status nginx</code> , opening the EC2 public IP in a browser returned: This site can't be reached.
Cause	The Security Group attached to the EC2 instance only had an inbound rule for port 22 (SSH). Port 80 (HTTP) had not been added, so all browser traffic was being silently blocked at the Security Group level before it could reach Nginx.
Solution	Opened EC2 → Security Groups → selected <code>web-server-sg</code> → Inbound rules → Edit inbound rules → added a new rule: Type = HTTP, Port Range = 80, Source = 0.0.0.0/0. Refreshed the browser and the Nginx page loaded immediately.

End of Troubleshooting Log · Mini Project 1 · Egwu Chidiebere Agha